

Viking Therapeutics (VKTX)

\$33.37 (Stock Price as of 08/18/2026)

Price Target (6-12 Months): **\$35.00**

Long Term: 6-12 Months

Zacks Recommendation:

Neutral

(Since: 08/18/26)

Prior Recommendation: Underperform

Short Term: 1-3 Months

Zacks Rank: (1-5)

3-Hold

Zacks Style Scores:

VGM:D

Value: D

Growth: F

Momentum: A

Summary

Viking reported a narrower-than-expected loss in the second quarter. The company is progressing with the development of its obesity drug candidate, VK2735, which has demonstrated superior weight reduction in both oral and subcutaneous formulations across clinical studies. Based on this success, the company has broadened its obesity pipeline by advancing another obesity candidate into clinical development, which utilizes a different treatment mechanism. While Viking is prioritizing the obesity space given its limited resources, it is exploring collaboration opportunities for its NASH and X-ALD programs. However, the company faces stiff competition in these indications from large pharmaceutical companies that dominate the obesity drug market through established products, large-scale manufacturing and global commercial reach. The stock has underperformed the industry year to date.

Data Overview

52 Week High-Low	\$43.15 - \$22.96
20 Day Average Volume (sh)	1,930,215
Market Cap	\$3.9 B
YTD Price Change	-5.2%
Beta	0.69
Dividend / Div Yld	\$0.00 / 0.0%
Industry	Medical - Biomedical and Genetics
Zacks Industry Rank	Bottom 41% (146 out of 247)

Last EPS Surprise	9.1%
Last Sales Surprise	NA
EPS F1 Est- 4 week change	5.1%
Expected Report Date	10/28/2026
Earnings ESP	0.0%

P/E TTM	NA
P/E F1	NA
PEG F1	NA
P/S TTM	NA

Price, Consensus & Surprise⁽¹⁾



Sales and EPS Growth Rates (Y/Y %)⁽¹⁾



Sales Estimates (millions of \$)⁽¹⁾

	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Annual*
2027	0 E	0 E	0 E	0 E	0 E
2026	0 A	0 A	0 E	0 E	0 E
2025	0 A	0 A	0 A	0 A	0 A

EPS Estimates⁽¹⁾

	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Annual*
2027	-0.85 E	-0.79 E	-0.76 E	-0.74 E	-4.08 E
2026	-1.37 A	-1.10 A	-1.00 E	-1.02 E	-4.47 E
2025	-0.41 A	-0.58 A	-0.81 A	-1.38 A	-3.19 A

*Quarterly figures may not add up to annual.

1) The data in the charts and tables, including the Zacks Consensus EPS and sales estimates, is as of 08/18/2026.

2) The report's text and the price target are as of 08/19/2026.

Overview

San Diego, CA-based Viking Therapeutics is a clinical-stage biopharmaceutical company focused on the development of novel first-in-class or best-in-class therapies for treating metabolic and endocrine disorders.

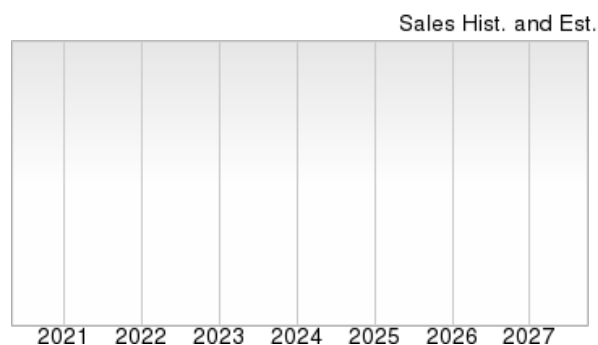
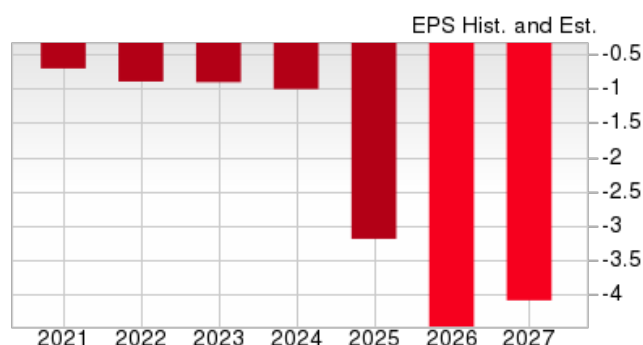
Viking Therapeutics is currently developing multiple pipeline candidates in early- to mid-stage clinical studies for obesity, biopsy-confirmed non-alcoholic steatohepatitis (NASH) and X-linked adrenoleukodystrophy (X-ALD) indications.

The company's lead pipeline drug is VK2735, an investigational, novel dual glucagon-like peptide-1 (GLP-1) and gastric inhibitory polypeptide (GIP) receptor agonist, which is being developed both as oral and subcutaneous (SC) formulations for treating obesity. Viking is also developing another obesity candidate, VK3019, an investigational dual amylin and calcitonin receptor agonist (DACRA).

Another candidate in Viking Therapeutics' pipeline is VK2809, an investigational selective thyroid hormone receptor beta (TR β) agonist, which completed a mid-stage study in patients with biopsy-confirmed NASH in 2024. The company is currently deciding its next steps regarding the further advancement of this candidate.

Both VK2735 and VK2809 are part of Viking's portfolio of five therapeutics programs that are based on small molecules licensed from Ligand Pharmaceuticals. Viking Therapeutics is also evaluating VK0214, a TR β agonist, in an early-stage study for X-ALD, a rare neurodegenerative disease.

Viking Therapeutics' portfolio is currently devoid of any approved products. As a result, the company has yet to generate any revenues.



As of 08/18/2026



As of 08/18/2026

Reasons To Buy:

- ▲ **Obesity Drug Development Encouraging:** The obesity market has garnered much interest lately. It is expected that the obesity market in the United States will reach \$100 billion by 2030.

Viking is one of the few biotech stocks that has shown immense potential in this space. VK2735 has shown blockbuster potential, having demonstrated superior weight reduction capabilities in clinical studies, both as an SC injection and an oral pill.

The company is conducting two late-stage studies (VANQUISH-1 and VANQUISH-2) on the SC formulation of VK2735 for 78 weeks. While VANQUISH-1 is evaluating the drug in obese adults with at least one weight-related co-morbid condition and without type II diabetes (T2D), VANQUISH-2 is assessing its efficacy in obese or overweight adults with T2D. Data from these studies are not expected before 2027.

Viking is on track to start late-stage studies on oral VK2735 in the fourth quarter of 2026. Management said the studies will broadly follow the VANQUISH framework but will be smaller in scale and shorter in duration.

Viking also initiated a maintenance dosing study on VK2735 in 2025. This study is evaluating multiple regimens — monthly SC, weekly oral and daily oral dosing — to check whether the initial weight loss achieved following weekly SC dosing of the drug can be sustained. The company expects to report SC maintenance results in the third quarter of 2026, followed by oral maintenance results in the first half of 2027.

In June 2026, Viking started a phase I study on VK3019, which is designed to activate amylin and calcitonin receptors. Management believes therapies targeting these receptors could potentially be used either as standalone treatments or in combination with VK2735 to improve weight-loss induction and support longer-term weight management. While still an early-stage candidate, VK3019 marks an important expansion of Viking's obesity pipeline beyond VK2735 and adds another mechanism that could broaden its future treatment options.

- ▲ **NASH Drug Shows Promise:** Viking completed the phase IIb VOYAGE study evaluating VK2809 as a potential treatment for patients with biopsy-confirmed NASH. The study showed a statistically significant reduction in liver fat content following 12 weeks of treatment with the drug. Overall data from the study showed that 40-50% of patients who received VK2809 achieved NASH resolution and at least a one-stage improvement in fibrosis compared with 20% in the placebo group.

Based on the above study results, we believe that the drug could rival Madrigal's Rezdiffra, which the FDA approved in March 2024 as the first-ever drug to treat NASH. Viking intends to pursue partnership opportunities for further development of the NASH drug.

- ▲ **Other Candidates Progressing Well:** A phase Ib study is evaluating orally administered VK0214 to treat adult male patients with adrenomyeloneuropathy (AMN), a form of X-ALD for which there are currently no pharmacologic treatment options. In October 2024, this study met its primary endpoint — a once-daily dose of VK0214 over 28 days was safe and well-tolerated in study participants. Treatment with the drug also significantly reduced plasma levels of very long-chain fatty acids and other lipids compared to placebo. Like VK2809, Viking is also pursuing collaboration prospects for the X-ALD drug.

- ▲ **Potential Buyout Target:** For a larger pharmaceutical company looking to expand its metabolic disease portfolio, Viking is an attractive acquisition target. With several large-cap biotech/pharma companies aiming to enter the lucrative obesity space, they could opt to acquire Viking Therapeutics to save time and avoid starting from scratch. An acquisition could also benefit Viking, as a clinical-stage biotech that lacks the distribution and supply chain to market its drugs post-approval.

We also remain optimistic about the company's NASH program, given the surge in acquisition interest around NASH drugs since early 2025, highlighted by deals such as Akero-Novo, 89bio-Roche and GSK-Boston Pharma.

- ▲ **Favorable Debt Profile:** Viking has an encouraging debt profile. As of June 30, 2026, the company had zero debt and cash, cash equivalents and marketable securities worth \$502 million. In the absence of any debt obligation, the company is less likely to file for bankruptcy in the event of insolvency.

Viking's pipeline progress with its lead obesity drug is encouraging.

Reasons To Sell:

- ▼ **Pipeline/Regulatory Setbacks:** While we believe Viking has an impressive pipeline, delayed approvals or development setbacks would negatively impact the stock. Gaining approval for pipeline candidates has become complicated with an increasingly stringent regulatory environment.

In August 2025, Viking reported that about 28% of patients who received oral VK2735 in the VENTURE-Oral Dosing study had discontinued treatment. The stock tanked post this announcement, even though the study achieved its primary endpoint. Though Viking assured investors that it might be able to mitigate the side effects of oral VK2735, the higher-than-expected discontinuation rates have raised questions about the drug's tolerability and safety profile. Any further setbacks could mar the stock's growth prospects.

The company currently lacks a stable stream of revenues, which is a concern.

- ▼ **Lack of Marketed Products:** With no approved product in its commercial portfolio, Viking lacks a source of regular income generation. The company has to shoulder significant cash burn due to ongoing clinical studies. Any developmental or regulatory setback to the ongoing studies will hurt the stock significantly. Its pipeline candidates are still undergoing clinical development and are yet to be commercialized.

Given its limited financial and operational resources, Viking has been forced to pause development in other therapeutic areas, including NASH and X-ALD, to focus almost entirely on the obesity segment. This heavy concentration in a single, highly competitive market increases business risk — any development delay or trial failure in the obesity program would have a disproportionate impact on the company's overall outlook. Until Viking secures collaboration partners or additional funding, the future of its non-obesity programs remains uncertain.

- ▼ **Stiff Competition in Targeted Markets:** Competition remains a major challenge for Viking. Its lead obesity candidate, VK2735, will directly compete with well-established players like Eli Lilly and Novo Nordisk, which already dominate the obesity treatment market through their approved drugs, strong global supply chains and vast commercialization experience. Beyond these leaders, several other large-cap pharmaceutical and biotech companies, including Roche, AstraZeneca, Merck, Pfizer and Amgen, are aggressively developing next-generation obesity and metabolic drugs. These rivals have far greater financial strength, R&D capacity and marketing reach, leaving limited room for Viking to establish a meaningful presence even if VK2735 succeeds clinically. This intense and growing competitive pressure continues to weigh on Viking's long-term growth prospects.

Viking also faces similar challenges for its NASH program, where companies such as Madrigal Pharmaceuticals, Novo Nordisk and GSK have already secured regulatory approvals or are advancing late-stage candidates. The presence of these established competitors with deep resources and strong development pipelines further limits Viking's competitive positioning.

Last Earnings Report

Q2 Earnings Beat Estimates Despite Surge in R&D Costs

Viking reported a second-quarter 2026 loss of \$1.10 per share, narrower than the Zacks Consensus Estimate of a loss of \$1.21. The reported loss, however, widened from a loss of 58 cents per share in the year-ago quarter due to higher operating expenses.

Currently, Viking does not have any approved products in its portfolio. It has yet to generate revenues.

Operating Costs Rise on Pipeline Work

Research and development expenses surged 92.4% year over year to \$115.8 million. The rise primarily reflected higher spending on clinical studies, salaries and benefits, stock-based compensation and third-party consultants.

General and administrative expenses climbed 16.8% to \$16.8 million. Higher consultant, legal and patent-service costs, salaries and benefits were partly offset by lower stock-based compensation.

VKTX Retains Cash Runway Into 2028

Viking ended the June quarter with \$502 million in cash, cash equivalents and short-term investments compared with \$603 million at the end of first-quarter 2026.

Management described the current period as the heaviest phase of cash usage for the VANQUISH studies. It expects spending to taper and reiterated that existing resources should fund operations into 2028.

FY Quarter Ending 12/31/2025

Earnings Reporting Date	Jul 29, 2026
Sales Surprise	NA
EPS Surprise	9.09%
Quarterly EPS	-1.10
Annual EPS (TTM)	-4.66

Recent News

Appoints New Director – July 23

Viking Therapeutics announced the appointment of Dorothy Gemmell to its Board of Directors, effective immediately, as the company advances its obesity and metabolic disease pipeline.

Gemmell brings more than 25 years of leadership experience across healthcare, digital health and commercialization, including executive roles at GoodRx, Capsule and Havas Life. She will advise on commercialization strategies as Viking seeks to strengthen its position in the rapidly growing obesity treatment market.

Initiates Phase I Study of VK3019 for Obesity – June 24

Viking Therapeutics announced the initiation of a phase I study evaluating VK3019, an investigational DACRA, in healthy adults with obesity. This study will assess the safety, tolerability and pharmacokinetics of single subcutaneous doses of the drug, while exploratory endpoints will evaluate changes in body weight following a single dose.

The study follows clearance of the investigational new drug (IND) application by the FDA and marks the first clinical evaluation of VK3019. Viking said therapies targeting amylin and calcitonin receptors could potentially be used alone or in combination with GLP-1 or dual GLP-1/GIP agonists to enhance weight loss induction and support long-term weight management, further expanding its obesity pipeline.

Valuation

Viking Therapeutics, Inc. shares have risen 8.3% over the past three months and 37% over the past year. In the past three months, the Zacks sub-industry has remained constant while the Zacks Medical Sector has risen 12.7%. Over the past year, the sub-industry has lost 3.3% while the broader sector has gained 12.5%.

The S&P 500 index is up 2.3% over the past three months and 20% over the past year.

The stock is trading at 9.5X trailing 12-month tangible book value per share, compared with 10.12X for the S&P 500. Over the past five years, the shares have traded between 0.9X and 25.59X, with a five-year median of 4.61X.

Our Neutral recommendation indicates that the stock will likely perform in line with the market. Our \$35.00 price target reflects 9.96X trailing 12-month tangible book value per share.

Industry Analysis⁽¹⁾ Zacks Industry Rank: Bottom 41% (146 out of 247)



Top Peers⁽¹⁾

Company (Ticker)	Rec	Rank
AbCellera Biologics Inc. (ABCL)	Neutral	3
Abcsi Corporation (ABSI)	Neutral	3
Altimune, Inc. (ALT)	Neutral	3
Amgen Inc. (AMGN)	Neutral	3
Structure Therapeutics Inc. Sponsored ADR (GPCR)	Neutral	3
GT Biopharma, Inc. (GTBP)	Neutral	4
Eli Lilly and Company (LLY)	Neutral	3
Novo Nordisk A/S (NVO)	Neutral	3

Industry Comparison ⁽¹⁾ Industry: Medical - Biomedical And Genetics				Industry Peers		
	VKTX	X Industry	S&P 500	GPCR	LLY	NVO
Zacks Recommendation (Long Term)	Neutral	-	-	Neutral	Neutral	Neutral
Zacks Rank (Short Term)	3	-	-	3	3	3
VGM Score	D	-	-	F	B	B
Market Cap	3.89 B	226.84 M	46.77 B	3.73 B	1,153.85 B	204.10 B
# of Analysts	11	3	22	7	9	7
Dividend Yield	0.00%	0.00%	1.31%	0.00%	0.56%	1.78%
Value Score	D	-	-	D	C	B
Cash/Price	0.13	0.31	0.04	0.35	0.01	0.02
EV/EBITDA	-9.20	-1.37	14.64	-17.15	43.02	9.07
PEG Ratio	NA	1.85	1.80	NA	1.46	4.14
Price/Book (P/B)	9.53	2.66	3.68	2.81	34.07	6.42
Price/Cash Flow (P/CF)	NA	14.58	15.28	NA	48.76	9.75
P/E (F1)	NA	21.51	18.87	NA	34.12	13.40
Price/Sales (P/S)	NA	7.16	3.09	NA	14.48	3.97
Earnings Yield	-13.40%	-14.38%	5.25%	-3.44%	2.93%	7.46%
Debt/Equity	0.00	0.00	0.56	0.00	1.41	0.59
Cash Flow (\$/share)	-3.26	-1.30	9.70	-4.12	25.14	4.69
Growth Score	F	-	-	F	A	D
Hist. EPS Growth (3-5 yrs)	NA%	8.11%	7.00%	NA	32.60%	26.08%
Proj. EPS Growth (F1/F0)	-40.13%	16.67%	12.47%	-29.58%	48.41%	-13.89%
Curr. Cash Flow Growth	190.59%	5.19%	8.31%	105.52%	75.86%	20.16%
Hist. Cash Flow Growth (3-5 yrs)	NA%	4.34%	9.15%	NA	22.66%	23.32%
Current Ratio	4.72	4.84	1.18	20.75	1.35	0.79
Debt/Capital	0.00%	0.00%	37.16%	0.00%	58.55%	36.98%
Net Margin	NA%	-99.62%	12.94%	NA	33.53%	35.36%
Return on Equity	-94.56%	-58.80%	17.55%	-25.56%	97.83%	61.20%
Sales/Assets	NA	0.32	0.54	NA	0.66	0.62
Proj. Sales Growth (F1/F0)	%	0.00%	7.29%	NA	35.40%	-3.60%
Momentum Score	A	-	-	F	B	A
Daily Price Chg	-0.77%	0.00%	-0.69%	-0.43%	3.60%	1.85%
1 Week Price Chg	-3.12%	0.00%	-0.47%	2.58%	-0.47%	-2.90%
4 Week Price Chg	-12.07%	1.12%	2.43%	8.47%	4.28%	-7.43%
12 Week Price Chg	8.34%	0.00%	2.30%	35.24%	15.12%	3.44%
52 Week Price Chg	36.99%	-3.30%	19.97%	184.73%	74.31%	-16.56%
20 Day Average Volume	1,930,215	363,892	2,880,926	554,315	2,644,691	13,593,126
(F1) EPS Est 1 week change	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
(F1) EPS Est 4 week change	5.06%	0.00%	0.63%	-12.65%	6.26%	0.76%
(F1) EPS Est 12 week change	4.38%	0.00%	1.14%	-12.65%	1.47%	-1.44%
(Q1) EPS Est Mthly Chg	8.26%	0.00%	0.00%	-20.16%	0.34%	2.82%

Zacks Stock Rating System

We offer two rating systems that take into account investors' holding horizons: Zacks Rank and Zacks Recommendation. Each provides valuable insights into the future profitability of the stock and can be used separately or in combination with each other depending on your investment style.

Zacks Recommendation

The Zacks Recommendation aims to predict performance over the next 6 to 12 months. The foundation for the quantitatively determined Zacks Recommendation is trends in the company's estimate revisions and earnings outlook. The Zacks Recommendation is broken down into 3 Levels; Outperform, Neutral and Underperform. Unlike many Wall Street firms, we have an excellent balance between the number of Outperform and Neutral recommendations. Our team of 70 analysts are fully versed in the benefits of earnings estimate revisions and how that is harnessed through the Zacks quantitative rating system. But we have given our analysts the ability to override the Zacks Recommendation for the 1200 stocks that they follow. The reason for the analyst over-rides is that there are often factors such as valuation, industry conditions and management effectiveness that a trained investment professional can spot better than a quantitative model.

Zacks Rank

The Zacks Rank is our short-term rating system that is most effective over the one- to three-month holding horizon. The underlying driver for the quantitatively-determined Zacks Rank is the same as the Zacks Recommendation, and reflects trends in earnings estimate revisions.

Zacks Style Scores

The Zacks Style Score is as a complementary indicator to the Zacks rating system, giving investors a way to focus on the highest rated stocks that best fit their own stock picking preferences.

Academic research has proven that stocks with the best Value, Growth and Momentum characteristics outperform the market. The Zacks Style Scores rate stocks on each of these individual styles and assigns a rating of A, B, C, D and F. We also produce the VGM Score (V for Value, G for Growth and M for Momentum), which combines the weighted average of the individual Style Scores into one score. This is perfectly suited for those who want their stocks to have the best scores across the board.

Value Score	D
Growth Score	F
Momentum Score	A
VGM Score	D

As an investor, you want to buy stocks with the highest probability of success. That means buying stocks with a Zacks Recommendation of Outperform, which also has a Style Score of an A or a B.

Disclosures

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